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Coexistence of reference signals in wireless communication networks

Abstract

Radio network node, wireless device, and related methods are described. According to one aspect, when a first radio access technology and a second radio access technology are coexisting on the same carrier, the symbol location of the reference signals of the first radio access technology may be moved or changed when the reference signals of the first radio access technology collide with the reference signals of the second radio access technology.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/279,983, filed Mar. 25, 2021, entitled "COEXISTENCE OF REFERENCE SIGNALS IN WIRELESS COMMUNICATION NETWORKS" which claims priority to International PCT Application No. PCT/IB2019/058131, filed Sep. 25, 2019 entitled "COEXISTENCE OF REFERENCE SIGNALS IN WIRELESS COMMUNICATION NETWORKS" which claimed priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/738,434 filed Sep. 28, 2018 entitled "COEXISTENCE OF REFERENCE SIGNALS IN WIRELESS COMMUNICATION NETWORKS", the entireties of all of which are incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present description generally relates to wireless communications and wireless communication networks, and more particularly relates to managing the coexistence of reference signals in wireless communication networks.

BACKGROUND

(2) In wireless communication systems like LTE and NR, a reference signal (RS) is typically transmitted to aid radio channel knowledge and also, sometimes, for tracking impairments induced by a local oscillator of a transceiver. The design of a reference signal will depend on its use case and several types of reference signals are needed in a wireless communication system. The main purpose of a reference signal will often be reflected by its name, though this is not always the case.

(3) For example, a reference signal designed and used for coherent demodulation of a physical layer channel is referred to as a demodulation reference signal (DMRS or DM-RS), a reference signal designed and used for acquiring channel state information in downlink is referred to as a channel state information reference signal (CSI-RS), and a reference signal designed for the tracking of time and frequency differences between transmitter and receiver is referred to as a tracking reference signal (TRS).

(4) In LTE, a common reference signal (CRS) was specified and has multiple purposes including mobility and new cell detection. The CRS can therefore never be disabled; it must always be transmitted in an LTE cell, even if there are no users served.

(5) Due to the wide range of use cases envisioned for NR, and also other factors, according to 3GPP agreements, each of the reference signals mentioned above is very configurable. They may occupy many different OFDM symbols within a slot of a radio frame and may also occupy different sets of subcarriers in each OFDM symbol.

(6) NR DMRS

(7) The NR DMRS can be configured with 1, 2, 3 or 4 DMRS symbols in a slot (where a slot has 14 OFDM symbols). The NR PDSCH can however be scheduled with duration shorter than 14 symbols. In such cases, the NR DMRS are moved closer to each other and are eventually dropped

when the NR PDSCH duration is too short to accommodate the configured number of DMRS symbols.

(8) An overview of NR DMRS positions can be seen in FIG. 1. Both single and double symbol DMRS are supported where double means that the DMRS symbols comes pairwise, using adjacent symbols. As can be seen in FIG. 1, as an example, if the NR PDSCH duration is 11 symbols and two additional DMRS symbols are configured, then they will be placed in symbol index 6 and 9, where symbol index number runs from 0 to 13. The position of the first symbol containing DMRS is either in the symbol with index 2 or 3 and is given by cell specific system information provided by the master information block (MIB).

(9) LTE CRS

(10) In LTE, the CRS positions in downlink subframes are dense and occupy resource elements symbol with slot indices 0, 4, 7, and 11 when 2 CRS ports are configured (denoted as LTE CRS ports 0 and 1) (see FIG. 2). In case 4 CRS ports are configured, the CRS occupy symbols with slot indices 0, 1, 4, 7, 8, and 11. However, in the case with 4 ports being configured, the third and fourth ports (CRS ports 2 and 3) are only used when receiving PDSCH and not for mobility measurements as these measurements are defined on LTE ports 0 and 1 only.

(11) NR LTE Coexistence

(12) It is possible to operate an NR carrier and an LTE carrier in the same frequency band. The wireless devices connected to the LTE carrier are unaware that there is a potential NR transmission when there is no ongoing LTE transmission. The wireless devices connected to the NR carrier can, on the other hand, be configured to be aware of a potential overlap with an LTE carrier. Since the LTE CRS cannot be disabled, the slot will not be empty even if there is no LTE traffic. Hence, when LTE and NR use the same subcarrier spacing, i.e. 15 kHz, the NR radio network node (e.g., gNB, NG-RAN node, etc.) provides signaling of the positions of the CRS to the NR wireless device(s), using at least the RRC parameters `lte-CRS-ToMatchAround` for the CRS positions and `nrofCRS-Ports` for the number of CRS ports (1, 2 or 4). This allows coexistence of LTE and NR on the same carrier as NR PDSCH can be mapped around the LTE CRS.

SUMMARY

(13) Though it is possible to operate an NR carrier and an LTE carrier in the same frequency band, a problem occurs when additional NR DMRS symbols are configured since for some NR PDSCH durations, at least some of the additional NR DMRS symbol(s) will be in the same symbol location as at least some of the LTE CRS symbol(s). This will corrupt the channel estimation for LTE or NR, depending on which reference signal the radio network node decides to puncture since it has to choose to transmit either the LTE CRS or the NR DMRS in the colliding resource elements.

(14) According to one aspect, some embodiments include a method performed by a radio network node operating according to a first radio access technology and a second radio access technology. The method generally comprises transmitting a downlink transmission to a wireless device operating according to the first radio access technology, the downlink transmission comprising reference signals of the first radio access technology, wherein the reference signals of the first radio access technology are located at a first symbol location within the downlink transmission when the reference signals of the first radio access technology are determined not to collide with reference signals of the second radio access technology, and wherein the reference signals of the first radio access technology are located at a second symbol location within the downlink transmission when the reference signals of the first radio access technology are determined to collide with the reference signals of the second radio access technology.

(15) In some embodiments, the method may comprise, or further comprise, transmitting an indication to the wireless device indicating that the first radio access technology and the second radio access technology are coexisting on a same carrier. In some embodiments, the indication may be transmitted in broadcast signaling or in dedicated signaling. In some embodiments, the indication may be transmitted in a System Information Block (SIB) message or in a Radio

Resource Control (RRC) message. In some embodiments, the indication may be a parameter in an information element of the RRC message. In some embodiments, the parameter may be the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter.

(16) In some embodiments, the second symbol location may be before the first symbol location. In such embodiments, the second symbol location may be at least one symbol before the first symbol location.

(17) In some embodiments, the second symbol location may be after the first symbol location. In such embodiments, the second symbol location may be at least one symbol after the first symbol location.

(18) In some embodiments, the first radio access technology may be the New Radio (NR) radio access technology. In some embodiments, the second radio access technology may be the Long Term Evolution (LTE) radio access technology.

(19) In some embodiments, the reference signals of the first radio access technology may be demodulation reference signals (DMRS). In some embodiments, the reference signals of the second radio access technology may be common or cell reference signals (CRS).

(20) According to another aspect, some embodiments include a radio network node adapted, configured, enabled, or otherwise operable, to perform one or more of the described radio network node functionalities (e.g. actions, operations, steps, etc.).

(21) In some embodiments, the radio network node may comprise one or more transceivers, one or more communication interfaces, and processing circuitry operatively connected to the one or more transceivers and to the one or more communication interfaces. The one or more transceivers are configured to enable the radio network node to communicate with one or more wireless devices over a radio interface. The one or more communication interfaces are configured to enable the radio network node to communicate with one or more other radio network nodes (e.g., via a radio access network communication interface), with one or more core network nodes (e.g., via a core network communication interface), and/or with one or more other network nodes. The processing circuitry is configured to enable the radio network node to perform one or more of the described radio network node functionalities. In some embodiments, the processing circuitry may comprise at least one processor and at least one memory, the memory storing instructions which, upon being executed by the processor, configure the at least one processor to enable the radio network node to perform one or more of the described radio network node functionalities.

(22) In some embodiments, the radio network node may comprise one or more functional units (also referred to as modules) configured to perform one or more of the described radio network node functionalities. In some embodiments, these functional units may be embodied by the one or more transceivers and the processing circuitry of the radio network node.

(23) According to another aspect, some embodiments include a computer program product. The computer program product comprises computer-readable instructions stored in a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of the computer program product. When the instructions are executed by processing circuitry (e.g., at least one processor) of the radio network node, they enable the radio network node to perform one or more of the described radio network node functionalities.

(24) According to another aspect, some embodiments include a method performed by a wireless device operating according to a first radio access technology. The method generally comprises receiving a downlink transmission from a radio network node operating according to the first radio access technology and according to a second radio access technology, the downlink transmission comprising reference signals of the first radio access technology, wherein the reference signals of the first radio access technology are located at a first symbol location within the downlink transmission when the reference signals of the first radio access technology are determined not to collide with reference signals of the second radio access technology, and wherein the reference signals of the first radio access technology are located at a second symbol location within the

downlink transmission when the reference signals of the first radio access technology are determined to collide with the reference signals of the second radio access technology.

(25) In some embodiments, the method may comprise, or further comprise, receiving an indication from the radio network node indicating that the first radio access technology and the second radio access technology are coexisting on a same carrier. In some embodiments, the indication may be received in broadcast signaling or in dedicated signaling. In some embodiments, the indication may be received in a System Information Block (SIB) message or in a Radio Resource Control (RRC) message. In some embodiments, the indication may be a parameter in an information element of the RRC message. In some embodiments, the parameter may be the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter.

(26) In some embodiments, the second symbol location may be before the first symbol location. In such embodiments, the second symbol location may be at least one symbol before the first symbol location.

(27) In some embodiments, the second symbol location may be after the first symbol location. In such embodiments, the second symbol location may be at least one symbol after the first symbol location.

(28) In some embodiments, the first radio access technology may be the New Radio (NR) radio access technology. In some embodiments, the second radio access technology may be the Long Term Evolution (LTE) radio access technology.

(29) In some embodiments, the reference signals of the first radio access technology may be demodulation reference signals (DMRS). In some embodiments, the reference signals of the second radio access technology may be common or cell reference signals (CRS).

(30) According to another aspect, some embodiments include a wireless device adapted, configured, enabled, or otherwise operable, to perform one or more of the described wireless device functionalities (e.g. actions, operations, steps, etc.).

(31) In some embodiments, the wireless device may comprise one or more transceivers and processing circuitry operatively connected to the one or more transceivers. The one or more transceivers are configured to enable the wireless device to communicate with one or more radio network nodes over a radio interface. The processing circuitry is configured to enable the wireless device to perform one or more of the described wireless device functionalities. In some embodiments, the processing circuitry may comprise at least one processor and at least one memory, the memory storing instructions which, upon being executed by the processor, enable the wireless device to perform one or more of the described wireless device functionalities.

(32) In some embodiments, the wireless device may comprise one or more functional units (also referred to as modules) configured to perform one or more of the described wireless device functionalities. In some embodiments, these functional units may be embodied by the one or more transceivers and the processing circuitry of the wireless device.

(33) According to another aspect, some embodiments include a computer program product. The computer program product comprises computer-readable instructions stored in a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of the computer program product. When the instructions are executed by processing circuitry (e.g., at least one processor) of the wireless device, they enable the wireless device to perform one or more of the described wireless device functionalities.

(34) Hence, in some broad embodiments, the NR DMRS which are determined to collide with LTE CRS are moved away from the colliding symbol position(s) when LTE CRS are present. The presence of the LTE CRS may be signaled to the wireless device using a parameter such as, but not limited to, the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter.

(35) Some embodiments may thus enable an NR PDSCH to be transmitted in the whole slot (14 symbols), leading to increased average throughput and peak throughput of NR when operating in coexistence with LTE.

(36) This summary is not an extensive overview of all contemplated embodiments, and is not

intended to identify key or critical aspects or features of any embodiments or to delineate any embodiments. Other aspects and features will become apparent to those ordinarily skilled in the art upon review of the following description of specific embodiments with the figures.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) Exemplary embodiments will be described in more detail referring to the following figures, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of different single-symbol and double-symbol DMRS configurations in NR.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of an example CRS configuration in LTE.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram of an example wireless communication network according to some embodiments.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram of a portion of an example wireless communication network showing example signaling according to some embodiments.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of NR DMRS puncturing when LTE CRS are present.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram of a possible solution when NR DMRS and LTE CRS are colliding.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a schematic diagram of NR DMRS being moved away from LTE CRS when NR DMRS and LTE CRS are colliding according to some embodiments.
- (9) FIG. 8 is a signaling diagram according to some embodiments.
- (10) FIG. 9 is a flow chart of operations of a radio network node according to some embodiments.
- (11) FIG. 10 is a flow chart of operations of a wireless device according to some embodiments.
- (12) FIG. 11 is a block diagram of a radio network node according to some embodiments.
- (13) FIG. 12 is another block diagram of a radio network node according to some embodiments.
- (14) FIG. 13 is a block diagram of a wireless device according to some embodiments.
- (15) FIG. 14 is another block diagram of a wireless device according to some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (16) The embodiments set forth below represent information to enable those skilled in the art to practice the embodiments. Upon reading the following description, given the accompanying figures, those skilled in the art will understand the concepts of the description and will recognize applications of these concepts not addressed herein. It should be understood these concepts and applications fall within the scope of the description.
- (17) In the following description, numerous specific details are set forth. However, it is understood that embodiments may be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known circuits, structures, and techniques have not been shown in order not to obscure the understanding of the description. Those of ordinary skill in the art, with the included description, can implement appropriate functionality without undue experimentation.
- (18) References in the specification to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “an example embodiment,” etc., indicate that the embodiment described may include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic, but every embodiment may not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a particular feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, it is submitted that it is within the knowledge of one skilled in the art to implement such feature, structure, or characteristic in connection with other embodiments whether or not explicitly described.
- (19) As used herein, the singular forms “a,” “an” and “the” should include the plural forms, unless the context indicates otherwise. It will be further understood that the terms “comprises,”

“comprising,” “includes,” and/or “including” when used, specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps, operations, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components, and/or groups thereof.

(20) Referring now to FIG. 3, an example of a wireless communication network **100** in which some embodiments may be deployed is depicted. The wireless communication network **100** generally enable wireless devices **110** to communicate with one or more external networks **400** via a radio access network **200** (also referred to a RAN) and a core network **300** (also referred to as CN).

(21) The radio access network **200** generally comprises a plurality of radio network nodes **210** (only two are shown for clarity) which are responsible for providing radio access, over a radio interface, to wireless devices **110** (only two are shown for clarity) via one or more cells **205**. Each cell **205** generally defines a geographical area associated to, and served by, a radio network node **210** where radio coverage is provided by the radio network node **210**. Notably, one radio network node **210** may serve more than one cell **205**, each of these cells **205** possibly covering different geographical areas.

(22) The core network **300**, which connects the radio access network **200** to one or more external networks **400**, generally comprises various core network nodes **310**. Though generally referred to as core network nodes **310**, these core network nodes **310** have different functions. For instance, some core network nodes **310** may be responsible for managing the connectivity of the wireless devices **110** within the wireless communication network **100** while other core network nodes **310** may be responsible for handling the transmission of data between the wireless devices and the one or more external networks **400**.

(23) Turning now to FIG. 4, additional details of the radio interface between a wireless device **110** and a radio network node **210** are shown. As illustrated, the radio interface generally enables the wireless device **110** and the radio network node **210** to exchange signals and messages in both a downlink direction, that is from the radio network node **210** to the wireless device **110**, and in an uplink direction, that is from the wireless device **110** to the radio network node **210**.

(24) The radio interface between the wireless device **110** and the radio network node **210** typically enables the wireless device **110** to access various applications or services provided by the one or more external networks which may be provided by a server **410** (also referred to as a host computer). The connectivity between the wireless device **110** and the server **410**, enabled at least in part by the radio interface between the wireless device **110** and the radio network node **210**, may be described as an over-the-top (OTT) connection. In such cases, the wireless device **110** and the server **410** are configured to exchange data and/or signaling via the OTT connection, using the radio access network **200**, the core network **300**, and possibly one or more intermediate networks (e.g., a transport network) (not shown). The OTT connection may be transparent in the sense that the participating network nodes (e.g., the radio network node, one or more core network nodes, one or more transport network node, etc.) through which the OTT connection passes may be unaware of the actual OTT connection they enable and support. For example, the radio network node **210** may not or need not be informed about the previous handling (e.g., routing) of an incoming downlink communication with data originating from the server **410** to be forwarded or transmitted to the wireless device **110**. Similarly, the radio network node **210** may not or need not be aware of the subsequent handling of an outgoing uplink communication originating from the wireless device **110** towards the server **410**.

(25) Broadly, when LTE and NR coexist on the same carrier (i.e., LTE and NR are operating in the same frequency band), the NR wireless device (also referred to as User Equipment or UE) can, if operating on 15 kHz subcarrier spacing, be informed about the position of the LTE CRS using the RRC parameter `lte-CRS-ToMatchAround`.

(26) However, as can be seen in FIG. 5, when an additional NR DMRS is configured for the wireless device, the additional NR DMRS may collide with the LTE CRS, leading to degraded

performance.

(27) One possible solution could be to schedule a shorter NR PDSCH, e.g., with a length of 12 or 11 OFDM symbols. In such cases, the additional NR DMRS would be at a symbol location which would not collide with the LTE CRS. However, as shown in FIG. 6, such a solution would imply a loss of about 15% in NR throughput compared to nominal since 2 out of 14 symbols would not be used, which may not be an acceptable solution in most cases.

(28) For DCI format 1_0 and before RRC configuration, two additional DMRS symbols are used and these will also collide with LTE CRS. However, in these cases, which are rarely used, it could be acceptable to schedule a 12-symbol NR PDSCH. For high capacity data however, it would be detrimental to NR performance in such coexistence scenario to take the 15% overhead on top of the already present LTE CRS overhead.

(29) Hence, in some embodiments, when LTE and NR coexist on the same carrier, the position of the (additional) NR DMRS is changed or otherwise shifted, based at least in part on the condition that the (additional) NR DMRS collide with the LTE CRS, and on the condition that the NR wireless device is made aware that LTE and NR coexist on the same carrier (e.g., on the condition that the NR wireless device is configured with LTE CRS for rate matching).

(30) In the following example embodiments, the description is for a single-symbol NR DMRS with one additional NR DMRS. However, the description can readily be extended to cover two and three additional NR DMRS as well as double-symbol NR DMRS with one additional NR DMRS. In these cases, the colliding NR DMRS symbols are moved to a nearby symbol position where they do not collide with LTE CRS.

(31) Furthermore, there are different locations where the colliding NR DMRS can be moved to. For example, in some embodiments, the colliding NR DMRS can be moved backward (or before) the colliding symbol location, e.g., from symbol index 11 to symbol index 10 (i.e., to symbol index $l_{\text{sub},1}=10$). In some other embodiments, the colliding NR DMRS can be moved forward (or after) the colliding symbol location, e.g., from symbol index 11 to symbol index 12 (i.e., to symbol index $l_{\text{sub},1}=12$). A possible advantage of moving the colliding DMRS forward to $l_{\text{sub},1}=12$ is reduced extrapolation of the radio channel.

(32) In some embodiments, if at least one of the NR DMRS symbols collide with LTE CRS, then all NR DMRS symbols are shifted by the same number of symbols (e.g., $n=2$) either forward or backward, to a position where none of the NR DMRS collides with LTE CRS.

(33) One embodiment is described as follows: For PDSCH mapping Type A, when `lte-CRS-ToMatchAround` is configured and `dmrs-AdditionalPosition='pos1'`, and single-symbol DMRS, then the DM-RS positions for PDSCH duration of 13 and 14 symbols are $l_{\text{sub},0}, 12$ instead of the default $l_{\text{sub},0}, 11$.

(34) Hence, the NR DMRS is moved one symbol forward (i.e., after the colliding symbol location) as shown in FIG. 7.

(35) In some embodiments, the following section of 3GPP TS 38.211 V15.2.0 may be modified as follows to enable one or more of the described embodiments.

(36) =====<<<<<3GPP TS 38.211>>>>=====

(37) 7.4.1.1.2 Mapping to Physical Resources

(38) [unchanged section(s) omitted]

(39) The position(s) of the DM-RS symbols is given by l and for PDSCH mapping type A, the duration is between the first OFDM symbol of the slot and the last OFDM symbol of the scheduled PDSCH resources in the slot for PDSCH mapping type B, the duration is the number of OFDM symbols of the scheduled PDSCH resources as signalled

(40) and according to Tables 7.4.1.1.2-3 and 7.4.1.1.2-4. The case `dmrs-AdditionalPosition` equal to 3 is only supported when `dmrs-TypeA-Position` is equal to 2. For PDSCH mapping type A, duration of 3 and 4 symbols in Tables 7.4.1.1.2-3 and 7.4.1.1.2-4 respectively is only applicable for `dmrs-TypeA-Position` equals 2. The value $l_{\text{sub},1}$ equals 12 if the higher layer parameter `lte-CRS-`

ToMatchAround is configured and 11 otherwise.

(41) [unchanged sections omitted]

(42) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 7.4.1.1.2-3 PDSCH DM-RS positions l for single-symbol DM-RS. DM-RS positions l PDSCH mapping type A type B Duration dmrs- dmrs- in AdditionalPosition AdditionalPosition symbols 0 1 2 3 0 1 2 3 2 — — — — l.sub.0 l.sub.0 3 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 — — 4 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 5 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 — — 6 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0, 4 7 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0 l.sub.0, 4 8 l.sub.0 l.sub.0, 7 l.sub.0, 7 l.sub.0, 7 — — 9 l.sub.0 l.sub.0, 7 l.sub.0, 7 l.sub.0, 7 — — 10 l.sub.0 l.sub.0, 9 l.sub.0, 6, 9 l.sub.0, 6, 9 — — 11 l.sub.0 l.sub.0, 9 l.sub.0, 6, 9 l.sub.0, 6, 9 — — 12 l.sub.0 l.sub.0, 9 l.sub.0, 6, 9 l.sub.0, 5, 8, 11 — — 13 l.sub.0 l.sub.0, l.sub.1 l.sub.0, 7, 11 l.sub.0, 5, 8, 11 — — 14 l.sub.0 l.sub.0, l.sub.1 l.sub.0, 7, 11 l.sub.0, 5, 8, 11 — —

(43) [unchanged sections omitted]

(44) =====<<<<<3GPP TS 38.211>>>>=====

(45) Referring to FIG. 8, a high-level signaling and operating diagram according to some embodiments is illustrated. The radio network node **210**, which is configured to operate according to both a first radio access technology (RAT) (e.g., NR) and a second RAT (e.g., LTE), transmits an indication to the wireless device **110**, which is configured to operate according to the first RAT (e.g., NR), that the two RATs are coexisting on the same carrier (and usually that the radio network node **210** operates according to both RATs) (action **S102**).

(46) The radio network node **210** may transmit the indication of coexistence of the two RATs (i.e., the coexistence indication) to the wireless device **110** in different ways. For instance, in some embodiments, the radio network node **210** may transmit the coexistence indication via broadcast signaling (e.g., via a System Information Block (SIB) message) or via dedicated signaling (e.g., via a Radio Resource Control (RRC) message). In some other embodiments, the coexistence indication may be an existing parameter reused for that purpose (e.g., a parameter in an Information Element of an RRC message such as the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter) or a new parameter designed for that purpose.

(47) After receiving the coexistence indication, the wireless device **110** will be aware that the radio network node **210** may perform downlink transmissions according to both RATs (e.g., according to both NR and LTE). Though the wireless device **110** may not need to monitor and decode the downlink transmissions transmitted according to the second RAT, the wireless device **110** may still have to consider the second RAT transmissions when monitoring and receiving the first RAT transmissions. For instance, the wireless device **110** may need to rate match around some of the reference signals sent according to the second RAT (e.g., the LTE CRS) when receiving a downlink transmission according to the first RAT.

(48) At some point in time, the radio network node **210** may need to schedule a downlink transmission to the wireless device **110**, for instance, to transmit some data (action **S104**). Using NR as an example, to transmit data to the wireless device **110**, the radio network node **210** will typically allocate resource for a downlink control channel carrying control information (e.g., an NR PDCCH) and for an associated downlink shared channel carrying the data addressed to the wireless device **110** (e.g., an NR PDSCH). To enable the proper demodulation of the transmitted downlink shared channel, demodulation reference signals (DMRS) will be included at one or more symbol locations within the downlink shared channel depending on the length or duration of the downlink shared channel and possibly on other parameters. In NR, the symbol locations of the DMRS are specified in section 7.4.1.1.2 of 3GPP TS 38.211 V15.2.0.

(49) Depending on the configuration of the reference signals of the first RAT (e.g., NR PDSCH DMRS), it is possible, as indicated above, that (at least some of) the reference signals of the first RAT would collide (i.e., be located at the same symbol location) with reference signals of the second RAT (e.g., LTE CRS). To avoid collision between the reference signals of the two RATs, the radio network node **210** may check or otherwise determine whether the reference signals of the first

RAT will collide with reference signals of the second RAT. If no collision is determined to be occurring between the reference signals of the two RATs, then the radio network node **210** will transmit the downlink transmission (e.g., NR PDCCH and NR PDSCH) with the reference signals of the first RAT at a first (or nominal) symbol location (action **S108**). Otherwise, if collision is determined to be occurring between the reference signals of the two RATs, the radio network node **210** will transmit the downlink transmission (e.g., NR PDCCH and NR PDSCH) with the reference signals of the first RAT at a second (or different) symbol location (action **S108**).

(50) It will be appreciated that if the downlink transmission comprises reference signals of the first RAT at multiple symbol locations, for instance as shown in FIG. 5 where the DMRS are located at both symbol index 2 and 11, it is possible to only change the symbol location of the reference signals of the first RAT which are determined to be colliding with reference signals of the second RAT. In FIG. 5, only the NR DMRS located at symbol index 11 are determined to be colliding. In such cases, only the reference signals of the first RAT determined to be colliding with reference signals of the second RAT can be moved or shifted to a different symbol location to avoid collision as shown in FIG. 7. In other embodiments however, all the reference signals of the first RAT may be moved to symbol locations which are not colliding with reference signals of the second RAT even if only one reference signal of the first RAT is colliding with reference signals of the second RAT.

(51) Once the wireless device **110** receives the downlink transmission, it will decode it knowing that the position of at least some reference signals of the first RAT may be at different symbol locations (action **S110**). Depending on the content of the downlink transmission, the wireless device **110** may perform one or more operational tasks associated with the content of the downlink transmission (action **S112**).

(52) It is to be noted that unless the description clearly indicates a certain relationship (e.g., causal, conditional, temporal, etc.) between two or more actions, the described actions may be performed in a different sequence than the one illustrated. For example, two actions shown performed in succession may be performed substantially concurrently, or even in the reverse order. Hence, the illustrated sequence of actions is only indicative of one particular sequence of actions and does not suggest that this is the only possible sequence.

(53) FIG. 9 is a flow chart illustrating operations of the radio network node **210** according to some embodiments. As illustrated, the radio network node **210** transmits an indication to a wireless device **110** (which may operate according to a first RAT (e.g., NR)) that the first RAT and a second RAT (e.g., LTE) are coexisting on the same carrier (action **S202**). As previously mentioned, the radio network node **210** may transmit this coexistence indication to the wireless device **110** in broadcast signaling (e.g., via a SIB message) or in dedicated signaling (e.g., via an RRC message). As also previously indicated, the coexistence indication may be an existing parameter (e.g., the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter) reused for that purpose or a new parameter designed for that purpose.

(54) The radio network node **210** may then schedule a downlink transmission for the wireless device **110**, for instance, to transmit some data (action **S204**). Using again NR as an example, to transmit data to the wireless device **110**, the radio network node **210** will typically allocate resource for a downlink control channel carrying control information (e.g., an NR PDCCH) and for an associated downlink shared channel carrying the data addressed to the wireless device **110** (e.g., an NR PDSCH). To enable the proper demodulation of the transmitted downlink shared channel, demodulation reference signals (DMRS) will be included at one or more symbol locations within the downlink shared channel depending on the length or duration of the downlink shared channel and possibly on other parameters. In NR, the symbol locations of the DMRS are specified in section 7.4.1.1.2 of 3GPP TS 38.211 V15.2.0.

(55) Depending on the configuration of the reference signals of the first RAT (e.g., NR PDSCH DMRS), it is possible, as indicated above, that (at least some of) the reference signals of the first

RAT would collide (i.e., be located at the same symbol location) with reference signals of the second RAT (e.g., LTE CRS). To avoid collision between the reference signals of the two RATs, the radio network node **210** may check or otherwise determine whether the reference signals of the first RAT will collide with reference signals of the second RAT (action **S206**). If no collision is determined to be occurring between the reference signals of the two RATs, then the radio network node **210** will transmit the downlink transmission (e.g., NR PDCCH and NR PDSCH) with the reference signals of the first RAT at a first (or nominal) symbol location (action **S208**). Otherwise, if collision is determined to be occurring between the reference signals of the two RATs, the radio network node **210** will transmit the downlink transmission (e.g., NR PDCCH and NR PDSCH) with the reference signals of the first RAT at a second (or different) symbol location (action **S208**). (56) It is to be noted that unless the description clearly indicates a certain relationship (e.g., causal, conditional, temporal, etc.) between two or more actions, the described actions may be performed in a different sequence than the one illustrated. For example, two actions shown performed in succession may be performed substantially concurrently, or even in the reverse order. Hence, the illustrated sequence of actions is only indicative of one particular sequence of actions and does not suggest that this is the only possible sequence.

(57) FIG. **10** is a flow chart illustrating operations of the wireless device **110** according to some embodiments. As illustrated, the wireless device **110** (which may operate according to a first RAT (e.g., NR)) may receive, from a radio network node **210**, an indication that the first RAT and a second RAT (e.g., LTE) are coexisting on the same carrier (action **S302**). As previously mentioned, the wireless device **110** may receive this coexistence indication in broadcast signaling (e.g., via a SIB message) or in dedicated signaling (e.g., via an RRC message). As also previously mentioned, the indication may be an existing parameter (e.g., the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter) reused for that purpose or a new parameter designed for that purpose.

(58) At some point in time, the wireless device **110** may receive a downlink transmission from the radio network node **210**. The downlink transmission comprises reference signals of the first RAT which are located at a first symbol location within the downlink transmission when the reference signals of the first RAT are determined not to collide with reference signals of the second RAT, and which are located at a second symbol location within the downlink transmission when the reference signals of the first RAT are determined to collide with the reference signals of the second RAT (action **S304**).

(59) Upon received the downlink transmission from the radio network node **210**, the wireless device **110** will decode it (action **S306**) and generally perform at least one operational task based on the decoded downlink transmission (action **S308**).

(60) Embodiments of a radio network node **210** will now be described in view of FIGS. **11** and **12**. Even though the expression radio network node is used throughout the description, it is to be understood that the expression is used generically. A radio network node generally refers to an equipment, or a combination of equipments, arranged, capable, configured, and/or operable to communicate directly or indirectly with a wireless device and/or with other network nodes (e.g., radio network nodes, core network nodes, etc.) in the wireless communication network to enable and/or provide wireless access to the wireless device and/or to perform other functions (e.g., administration) in the wireless communication network.

(61) Notably, different communication standards may use different terminology when referring to or describing radio network node. For instance, 3GPP uses the terms Node B (NB), evolved Node B (eNB), next-generation Node B (gNB), Next-Generation Radio Access Node (NG-RAN node), Radio Network Controller (RNC), and Base Station (BS). 3GPP2 uses the terms Access Node (AN), Base Station (BS), and Base Station Controller (BSC). And IEEE 802.11 (also known as WiFi™) uses the access point (AP). Understandably, the generic expression radio network node encompasses these terms.

(62) FIG. **11** is a block diagram of an exemplary radio network node **210** according to some

embodiments. As illustrated, radio network node **210** may include one or more of a transceiver **212**, processor **214**, memory **216**, and communication interface(s) **224**. The transceiver **212** enables the radio network node **210** to transmit wireless signals to and receiving wireless signals from wireless device **110** (e.g., via transmitter(s) (Tx) **218**, receiver(s) (Rx) **220**, and antenna(s) **222**). The processor **214** executes instructions to provide some or all of the functionalities described as being provided by the radio network node **210**. The memory **216** stores the instructions to be executed by the processor **214** and may also store data during operation of the radio network node **210**. In some embodiments, the processor **214** and the memory **216** may form processing circuitry **226**. The communication interface(s) **224** enable the radio network **210** to communicate with other network nodes, including other radio network nodes **210** (via a radio access network interface) and core network nodes **310** (via a core network interface).

(63) The processor **214** may include any suitable combination of hardware to execute instructions and manipulate data to perform some or all of the described functions of radio network node **210**, such as those described above. In some embodiments, the processor **214** may include, for example, one or more computers, one or more central processing units (CPUs), one or more microprocessors, one or more application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), one or more field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs) and/or other logic.

(64) The memory **216** is generally operable to store instructions, such as a computer program, software, an application including one or more of logic, rules, algorithms, code, tables, etc. and/or other instructions capable of being executed by a processor **214**. Examples of memory **216** include computer memory (for example, Random Access Memory (RAM) or Read Only Memory (ROM)), mass storage media (for example, a hard disk), removable storage media (for example, a Compact Disk (CD) or a Digital Video Disk (DVD)), and/or or any other volatile or non-volatile, non-transitory computer-readable and/or computer-executable memory devices that store information, data, and/or instructions that may be used by the processor **214** of radio network node **210**.

(65) In some embodiments, the communication interface **224** is communicatively coupled to the processor **214** and may refer to any suitable device operable to receive input for radio network node **210**, send output from radio network node **210**, perform suitable processing of the input or output or both, communicate to other devices, or any combination of the preceding. The communication interface may include appropriate hardware (e.g., port, modem, network interface card, etc.) and software, including protocol conversion and data processing capabilities, to communicate through a network.

(66) Other embodiments of radio network node **210** may include additional components beyond those shown in FIG. **11** that may provide certain aspects of the radio network node's functionalities, including any of the functionalities described above and/or any additional functionalities (including any functionality necessary to support the solutions described above). The various different types of network nodes may include components having the same physical hardware but configured (e.g., via programming) to support different radio access technologies, or may represent partly or entirely different physical components.

(67) FIG. **12** is a block diagram of another exemplary radio network node **210** according to some embodiments. As illustrated, in some embodiments, the radio network node **210** may comprise modules (or units) **228** configured to implement some or all of the functionalities of the radio network node **210** described above. It will be appreciated that the modules **228** may be implemented as combination of hardware and/or software, for instance, the processor **214**, memory **216**, and transceiver(s) **212** of radio network node **210** in FIG. **11**. Some embodiments may also include additional modules **228** to support additional and/or optional functionalities.

(68) Some embodiments of a wireless device (WD) **110** will now be described in view of FIGS. **13** and **14**. Even though the expression wireless device is used throughout the description, it is to be understood that the expression is used generically. A wireless device generally refers to a device arranged, capable, configured, and/or operable to communicate wirelessly with one or more

network nodes (e.g., radio network nodes) and/or with one or more other wireless devices. In some embodiments, a wireless device may be configured to transmit and/or receive information without direct human interaction. Such a wireless device may be called a Machine Type Communication (MTC) device or as a Machine-to-Machine (M2M) device.

(69) Notably, different communication standards may use different terminology when referring to or describing wireless device. For instance, 3GPP uses the terms User Equipment (UE), Mobile Equipment (ME) and Mobile Terminal (MT). 3GPP2 uses the terms Access Terminal (AT) and Mobile Station (MS). And IEEE 802.11 (also known as WiFi™) uses the term station (STA). Understandably, the generic expression wireless device encompasses these terms.

(70) FIG. 13 is a block diagram of an exemplary wireless device **110** according to some embodiments. Wireless device **110** includes one or more of a transceiver **112**, processor **114**, and memory **116**. In some embodiments, the transceiver **112** facilitates transmitting wireless signals to and receiving wireless signals from radio network node **210** (e.g., via transmitter(s) (Tx) **118**, receiver(s) (Rx) **120**, and antenna(s) **122**). The processor **114** executes instructions to provide some or all of the functionalities described above as being provided by wireless device **110**, and the memory **116** stores the instructions to be executed by the processor **114** and may also store data during operation of the wireless device **110**. In some embodiments, the processor **114** and the memory **116** form processing circuitry **124**.

(71) The processor **114** may include any suitable combination of hardware to execute instructions and manipulate data to perform some or all of the described functions of wireless device **110**, such as the functions of wireless device **110** described above. In some embodiments, the processor **114** may include, for example, one or more computers, one or more central processing units (CPUs), one or more microprocessors, one or more application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), one or more field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs) and/or other logic.

(72) The memory **116** is generally operable to store instructions, such as a computer program, software, an application including one or more of logic, rules, algorithms, code, tables, etc. and/or other instructions capable of being executed by a processor **114**. Examples of memory **116** include computer memory (for example, Random Access Memory (RAM) or Read Only Memory (ROM)), mass storage media (for example, a hard disk), removable storage media (for example, a Compact Disk (CD) or a Digital Video Disk (DVD)), and/or or any other volatile or non-volatile, non-transitory computer-readable and/or computer-executable memory devices that store information, data, and/or instructions that may be used by the processor **114** of wireless device **110**.

(73) Other embodiments of wireless device **110** may include additional components beyond those shown in FIG. 13 that may be responsible for providing certain aspects of the wireless device's functionalities, including any of the functionalities described above and/or any additional functionalities (including any functionality necessary to support the solution described above). As just one example, wireless device **110** may include input devices and circuits, output devices, and one or more synchronization units or circuits, which may be part of the processor. Input devices include mechanisms for entry of data into wireless device **110**. As an example, wireless device **110** may include additional hardware **126** such as input devices and output devices. Input devices include input mechanisms such as microphone, input elements, display, etc. Output devices include mechanisms for outputting data in audio, video and/or hard copy format. For example, output devices may include a speaker, a display, etc.

(74) FIG. 14 is a block diagram of another exemplary wireless device **110** according to some embodiments. As illustrated, in some embodiments, the wireless device **110** may comprise modules (or units) **128** configured to implement some or all of the functionalities of the wireless device **110** described above. It will be appreciated that the modules **128** may be implemented as combination of hardware and/or software, for instance, the processor **114**, memory **116**, and transceiver(s) **112** of wireless device **110** in FIG. 13. Some embodiments may also include additional modules **128** to support additional and/or optional functionalities.

(75) Some embodiments may be represented as a non-transitory software product stored in a machine-readable medium (also called a computer-readable medium, a processor-readable medium, or a computer usable medium having a computer-readable program code embodied therein). The machine-readable medium may be any suitable tangible medium including a magnetic, optical, or electrical storage medium including a diskette, compact disk read only memory (CD-ROM), digital versatile disc read only memory (DVD-ROM) memory device (volatile or non-volatile), or similar storage mechanism. The machine-readable medium may contain various sets of instructions, code sequences, configuration information, or other data, which, when executed, cause a processor to perform steps in a method according to one or more of the described embodiments. Those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that other instructions and operations necessary to implement the described embodiments may also be stored on the machine-readable medium. Software running from the machine-readable medium may interface with circuitry to perform the described tasks.

(76) The above-described embodiments are examples only. Alterations, modifications and variations may be effected to the particular embodiments by those of skill in the art without departing from the scope of the description.

ABBREVIATIONS AND ACRONYMS

(77) The present description may comprise these abbreviations and/or acronyms:

(78) TABLE-US-00002 3GPP Third Generation Partnership Project AMF Access Management Function CN Core Network CRS Common Reference Signal CSI-RS Channel State Information Reference Signal D2D Device-to-Device DCI Downlink Control Information DMRS DeModulation Reference Signal eNB evolved Node B EPC Evolved Packet Core E-UTRAN Evolved Universal Terrestrial Radio Access Network GGSN Gateway GPRS Support Node gNB Next Generation Node B (a Node B supporting NR) LTE Long Term Evolution MME Mobility Management Entity NB Node B NGC Next Generation Core NG-RAN Next-Generation Radio Access Network NR New Radio OFDM Orthogonal Frequency Division Multiplexing PDSCH Physical Downlink Shared CHannel PGW Packet Data Network Gateway RAN Radio Access Network RNC Radio Network Controller RS Reference Signal TRS Tracking Reference Signal UE User Equipment

RELATED STANDARD REFERENCES

(79) The following references may be related to the present description: 3GPP TS 38.211 V15.2.0 3GPP TS 38.214 V15.2.0 3GPP TS 38.331 V15.2.1

Claims

1. A method in a radio network node for reference signal collision avoidance between a first radio access technology and a second radio access technology coexisting on a same carrier and using a same subcarrier spacing, the radio network node operating according to a first radio access technology, the method comprising: transmitting a downlink transmission to a wireless device operating according to the first radio access technology, the downlink transmission including reference signals of the first radio access technology; the reference signals of the first radio access technology being located at a first symbol location within the downlink transmission when an lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is not configured to the wireless device; and the reference signals of the first radio access technology being located at a second symbol location within the downlink transmission when an lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is configured to the wireless device, the second symbol location being either before the first symbol location or after the first symbol location.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is configured to the wireless device in an information element of a Radio Resource Control, RRC, message.
3. The method of claim 2, further comprising transmitting the information element of the Radio

Resource Control, RRC, message to the wireless device.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the second symbol location is either at least one symbol before the first symbol location or at least one symbol after the first symbol location.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the reference signals of the first radio access technology are demodulation reference signals, DMRS.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein the reference signals of the second radio access technology are common or cell reference signals, CRS.

7. A radio network node configured to operate according to a first radio access technology and a second radio access technology, the first and second radio access technologies using a same subcarrier spacing, the radio network node configured to: transmit a downlink transmission to a wireless device operating according to the first radio access technology, the downlink transmission including reference signals of the first radio access technology; the reference signals of the first radio access technology being located at a first symbol location within the downlink transmission when an lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is not configured to the wireless device; and the reference signals of the first radio access technology being located at a second symbol location within the downlink transmission when an lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is configured to the wireless device, the second symbol location being either before the first symbol location or after the first symbol location.

8. The radio network node of claim 7, wherein the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is configured to the wireless device in an information element of a Radio Resource Control, RRC, message.

9. The radio network node of claim 8, further comprising transmitting the information element of the Radio Resource Control, RRC, message to the wireless device.

10. The radio network node of claim 7, wherein the second symbol location is either at least one symbol before the first symbol location or at least one symbol after the first symbol location.

11. The radio network node of claim 7, wherein the reference signals of the first radio access technology are demodulation reference signals, DMRS.

12. The radio network node of claim 7, wherein the reference signals of the second radio access technology are common or cell reference signals, CRS.

13. A method in a wireless device for reference signal collision avoidance between a first radio access technology and a second radio access technology coexisting on a same carrier and using a same subcarrier spacing, the wireless device operating according to the first radio access technology, the method comprising: receiving a downlink transmission from a radio network node operating according to the first radio access technology, the downlink transmission including reference signals of the first radio access technology; the reference signals of the first radio access technology being located at a first symbol location within the downlink transmission when an lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is not configured to the wireless device; and the reference signals of the first radio access technology being located at a second symbol location within the downlink transmission when an lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is configured to the wireless device, the second symbol location being either before the first symbol location or after the first symbol location.

14. The method of claim 13, wherein the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is configured to the wireless device in an information element of a Radio Resource Control, RRC, message from the radio network node.

15. The method of claim 14, further comprising receiving the information element of the Radio Resource Control, RRC, message from the radio network node.

16. The method of claim 13, wherein the second symbol location is either at least one symbol before the first symbol location or at least one symbol after the first symbol location.

17. The method of claim 13, wherein the reference signals of the first radio access technology are demodulation reference signals, DMRS.

18. The method of claim 13, wherein the reference signals of the second radio access technology are common or cell reference signals, CRS.

19. A wireless device configured to operate according to a first radio access technology, the wireless device configured to: receive a downlink transmission from a radio network node operating according to the first radio access technology, the downlink transmission including reference signals of the first radio access technology; the reference signals of the first radio access technology being located at a first symbol location within the downlink transmission when an lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is not configured to the wireless device; and the reference signals of the first radio access technology being located at a second symbol location within the downlink transmission when an lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is configured to the wireless device, the second symbol location being either before the first symbol location or after the first symbol location.

20. The wireless device of claim 19, wherein the lte-CRS-ToMatchAround parameter is configured to the wireless device in an information element of a Radio Resource Control, RRC, message from the radio network node.
